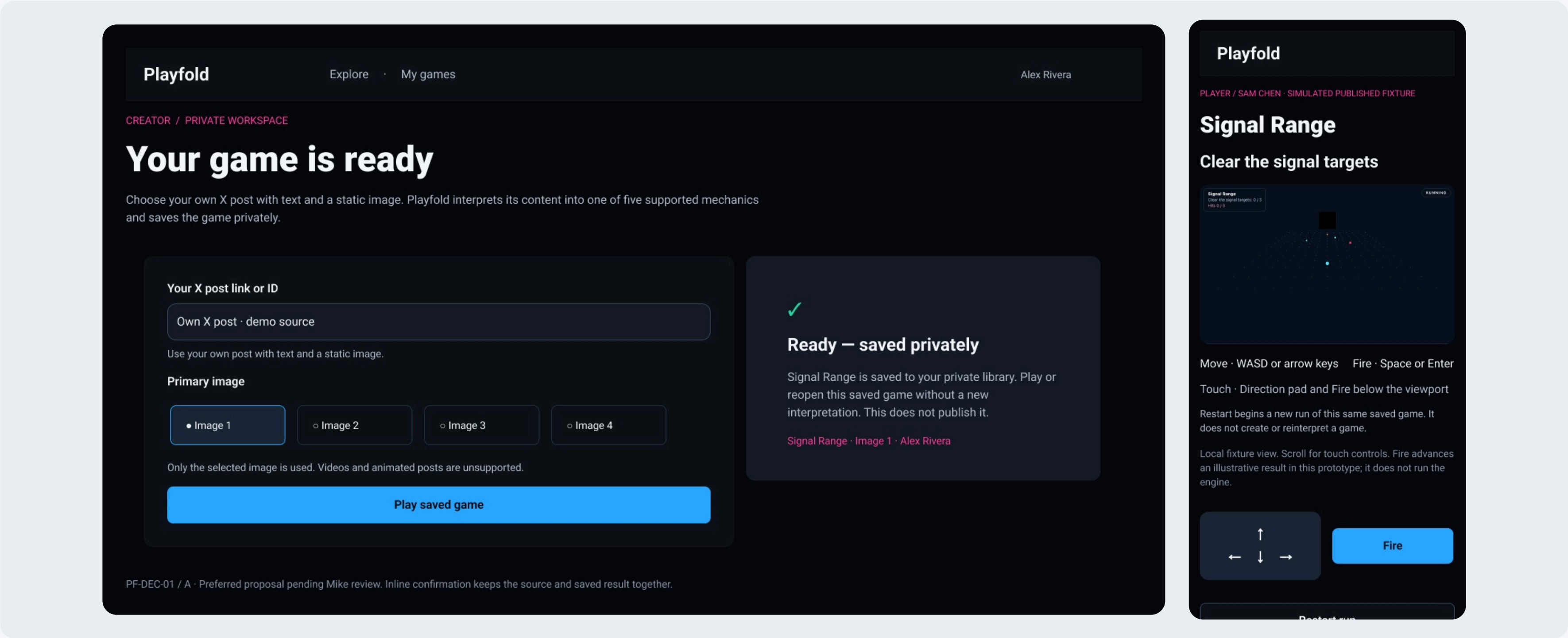


A source becomes something playable

Mike Chaves, founder of Wizzo Labs, owns Playfold’s product direction, interaction design, visual language and engineering. This case study connects the creator’s source, a private saved result and the player’s next action. It uses one illustrative game, Signal Range, to make the decisions comparable. Current creation is disabled; a separate prototype simulates the gated flow. The new private-result refinement is a recommendation pending Mike’s review.



baseline plus simulated scenario

Keep the source relationship legible

Playfold starts from source material instead of a blank game prompt. The current private creator accepts the signed-in person’s own X post with text and a static image. Source author and game creator remain separate concepts, even when one person fills both roles. Keeping those labels distinct helps the player understand origin without implying that attribution grants redistribution rights.

Source · Alex Rivera

Own X post · demo source
Text + Image 1

Attribution identifies origin; it does not grant redistribution rights.

Game · Alex Rivera

Signal Range
Clear the signal targets

A private saved result preserves a separate game identity.

source-backed baseline

One scenario across every decision

Alex Rivera wants to create, inspect and reopen Signal Range privately. The selected source says: “Calibrate a signal array by clearing unstable beacons before the interference swallows the range.” Image 1 is the local signal-grid fixture. Sam Chen later opens a simulated published version of the same game. Its objective is Clear the signal targets: three targets, with failure after three hits. These values describe the task, not product usage.

Alex · creator

Create, inspect and reopen
Signal Range privately.

Selected source: Image 1 in the
owned post.

Signal Range

Clear the signal targets.

3 targets · maximum 3 hits
Illustrative game rules.

Sam · player

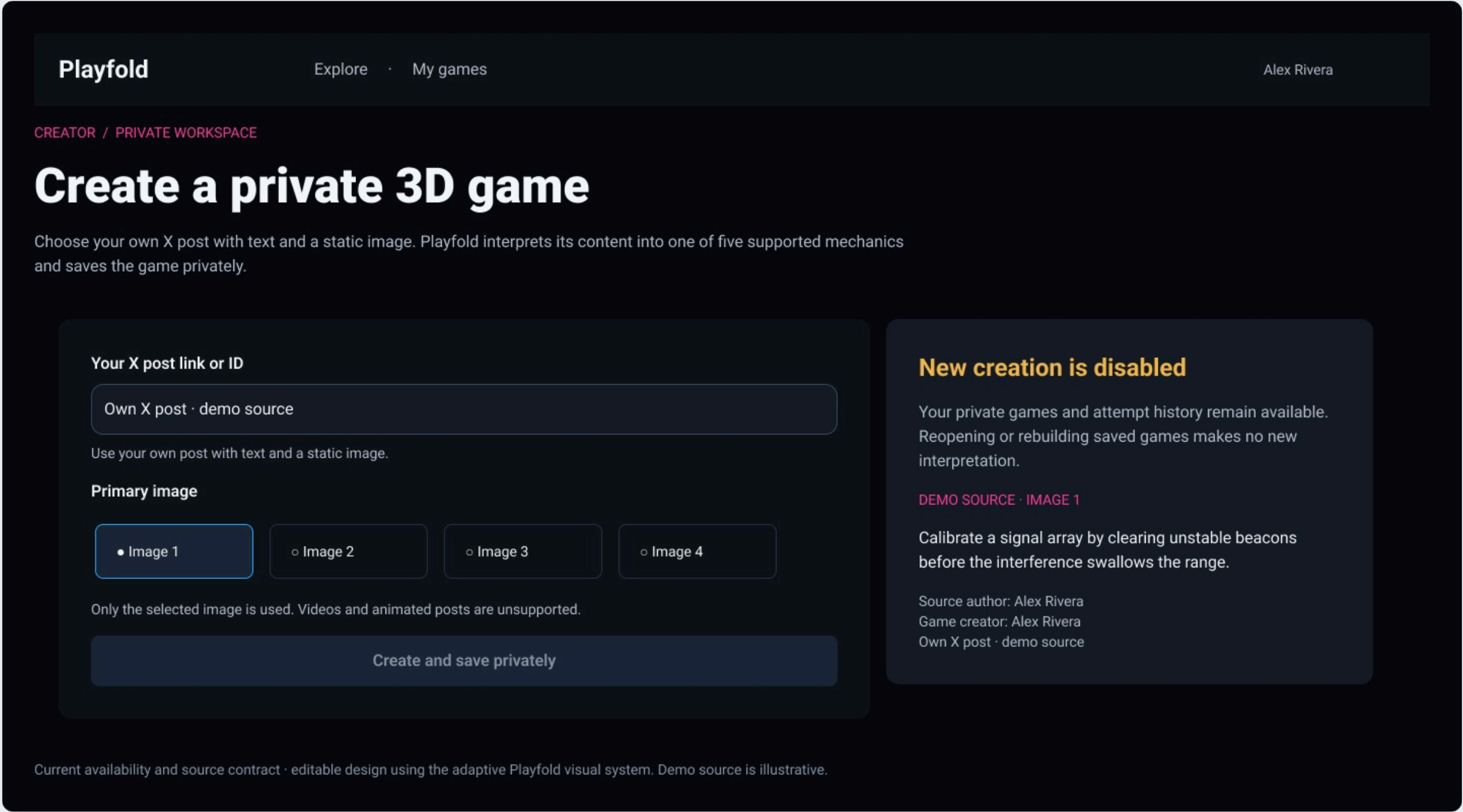
Open the same game in a
simulated published context.

Read the controls, play, restart
and return.

illustrative fixture

Bound the input before creation

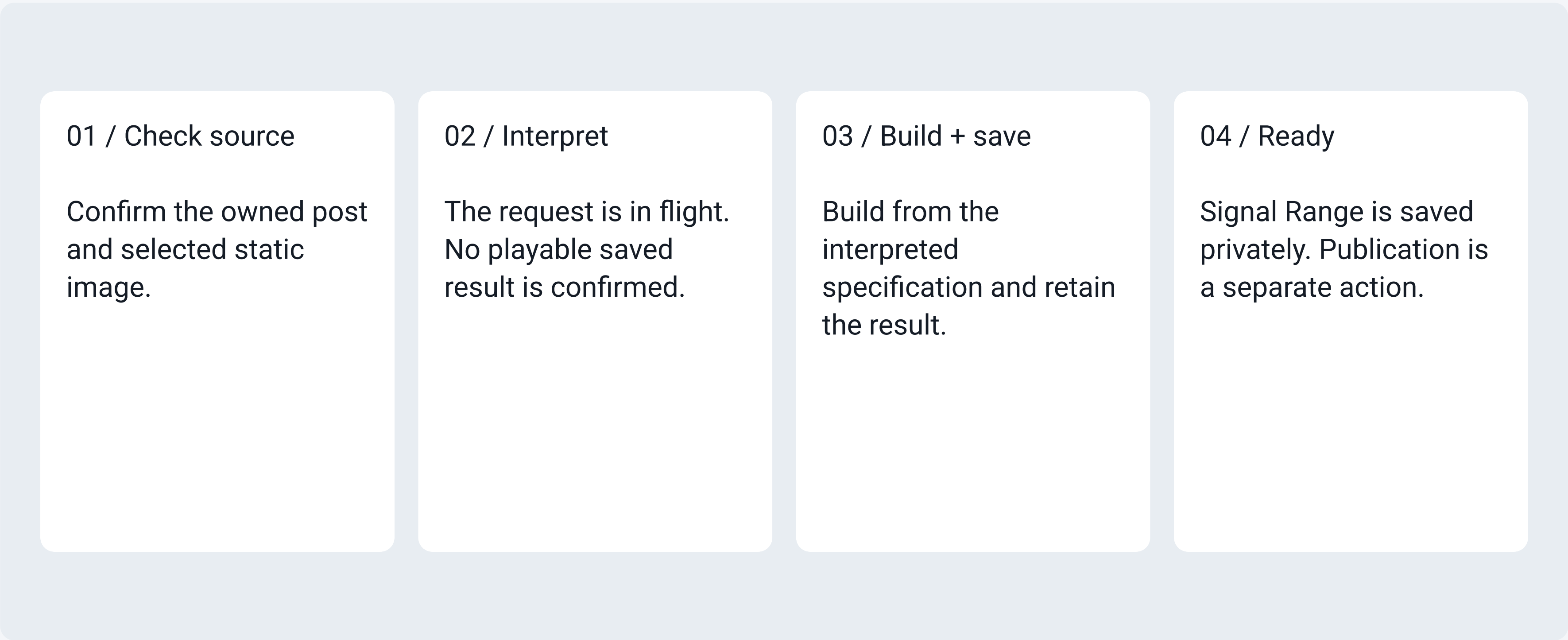
The current form asks for Your X post link or ID and Primary image. The selector offers Image 1 through Image 4 in the post; only the chosen image is used. Videos and animated posts are unsupported in this creator flow. The baseline keeps Create and save privately disabled while allowing access to saved work. The separate simulated entry explores the workflow without making generation available.



source-backed disabled baseline

Name the outcome accurately

Checking source, Interpreting and Building and saving communicate different stages. A generated candidate is not yet a playable saved result. Ready — saved privately confirms that the retained specification and image are available to the owner. The original action already requested private saving, so the result does not introduce a second Save step. Publication remains outside this sequence.



simulated implemented flow

Cancellation cannot undo an outcome

Cancel remaining creation requests a stop to remaining work. An interpretation already in flight may still finish, so the intermediate state says cancellation requested and waits for the outcome. The cancel action becomes unavailable while that request is pending. A late private result must retain its identity and explain what happened; a prototype must not jump straight to a promise that nothing was created.

Remaining work

Cancel remaining creation requests a stop.

It cannot undo an interpretation already in flight.

Request pending

Repeated cancellation is unavailable.

Wait for the final outcome of this same attempt.

Resolve honestly

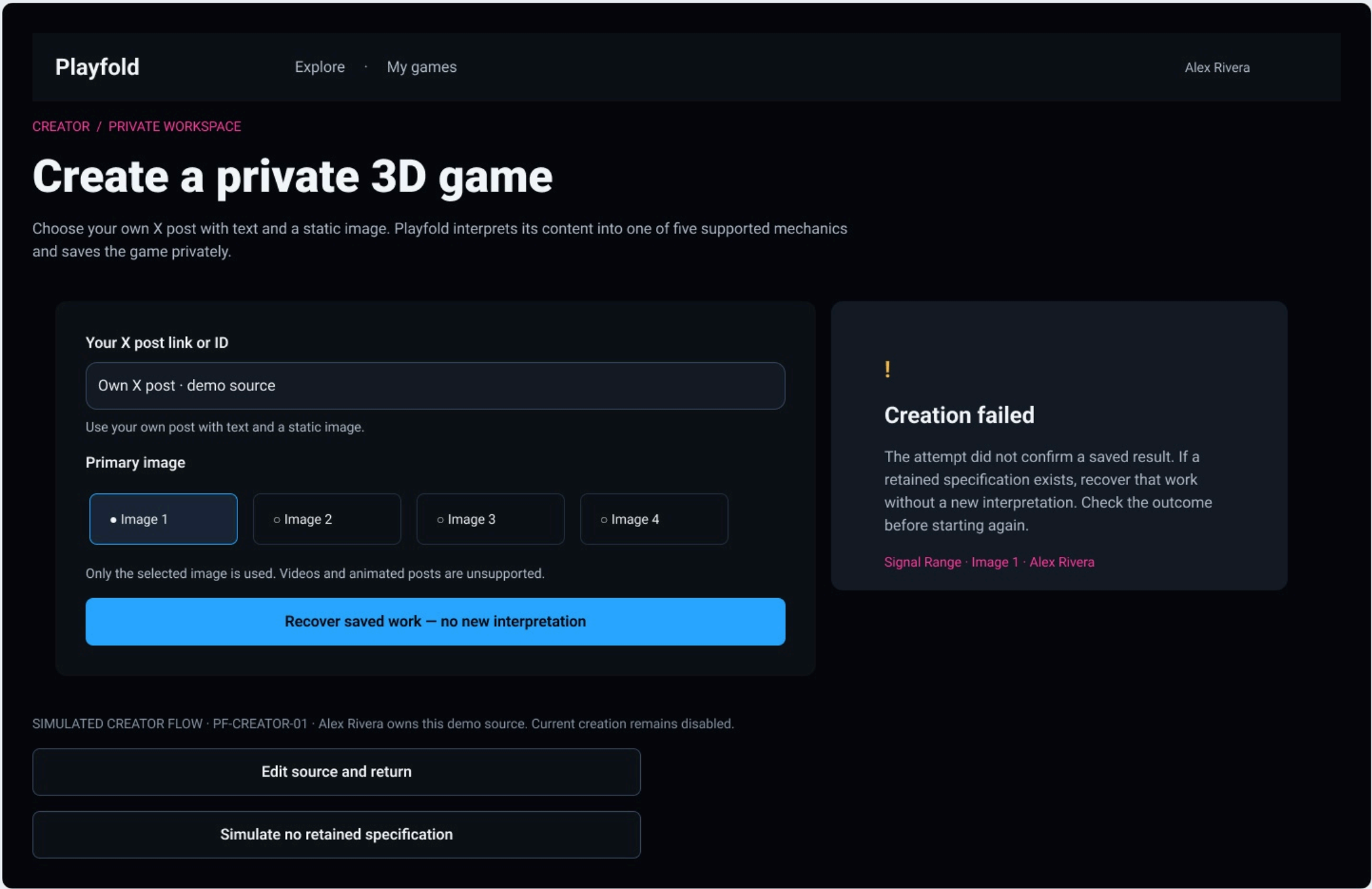
Late saved result → explain private save.

Failure → review or recover retained work.

simulated implemented flow

Recovery should preserve the attempt

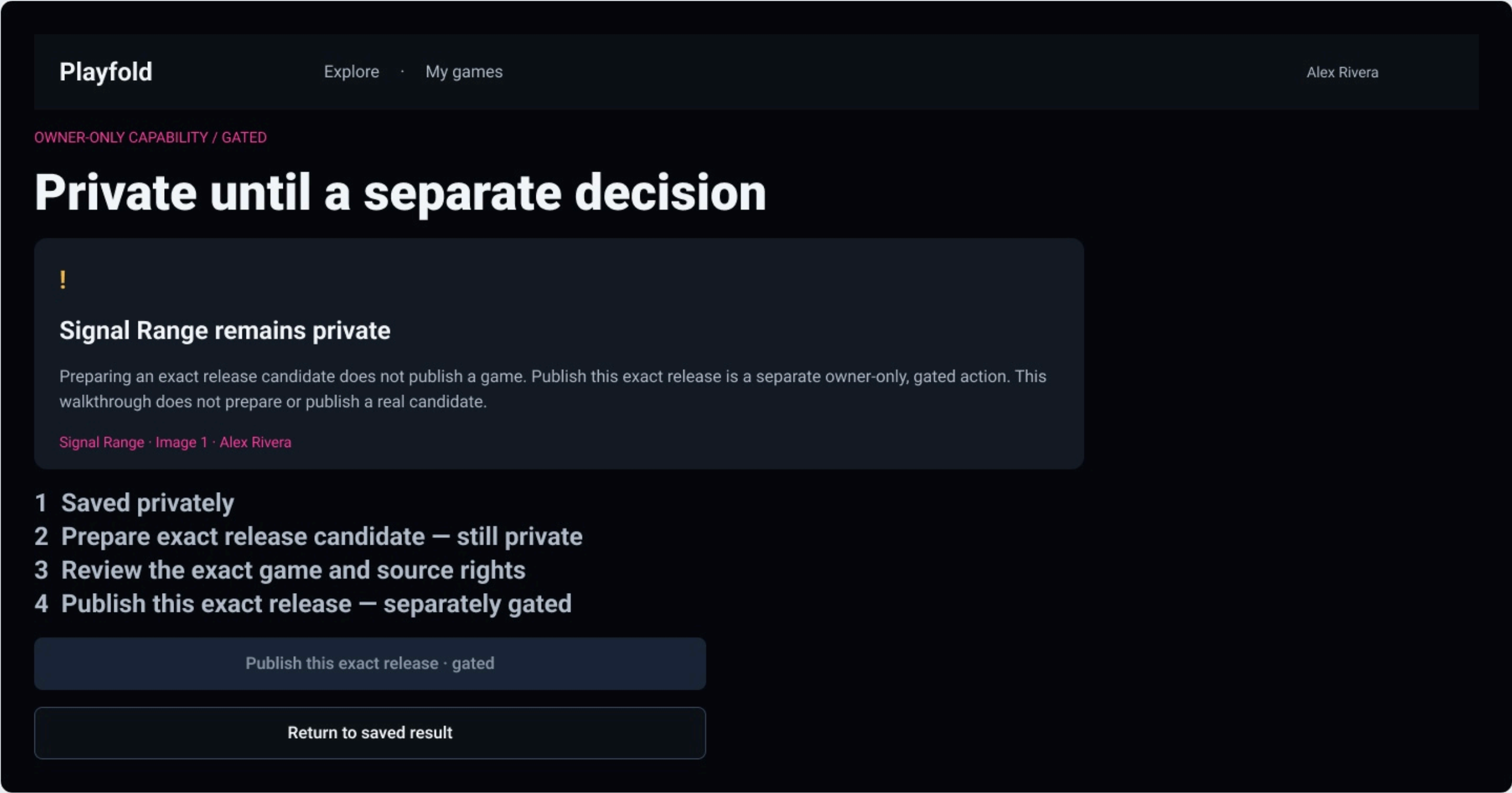
Creation failed and Outcome needs review need different explanations from ordinary waiting. Recover saved work — no new interpretation uses any valid saved specification; it may fail when none exists. The inspected app also offers Rebuild from saved spec for retained work. The prototype separates its recovery path from the preferred saved receipt. Reopening Signal Range from private history returns to the same result and selected source; it does not request a new interpretation.



source-backed recovery semantics

Private is a meaningful boundary

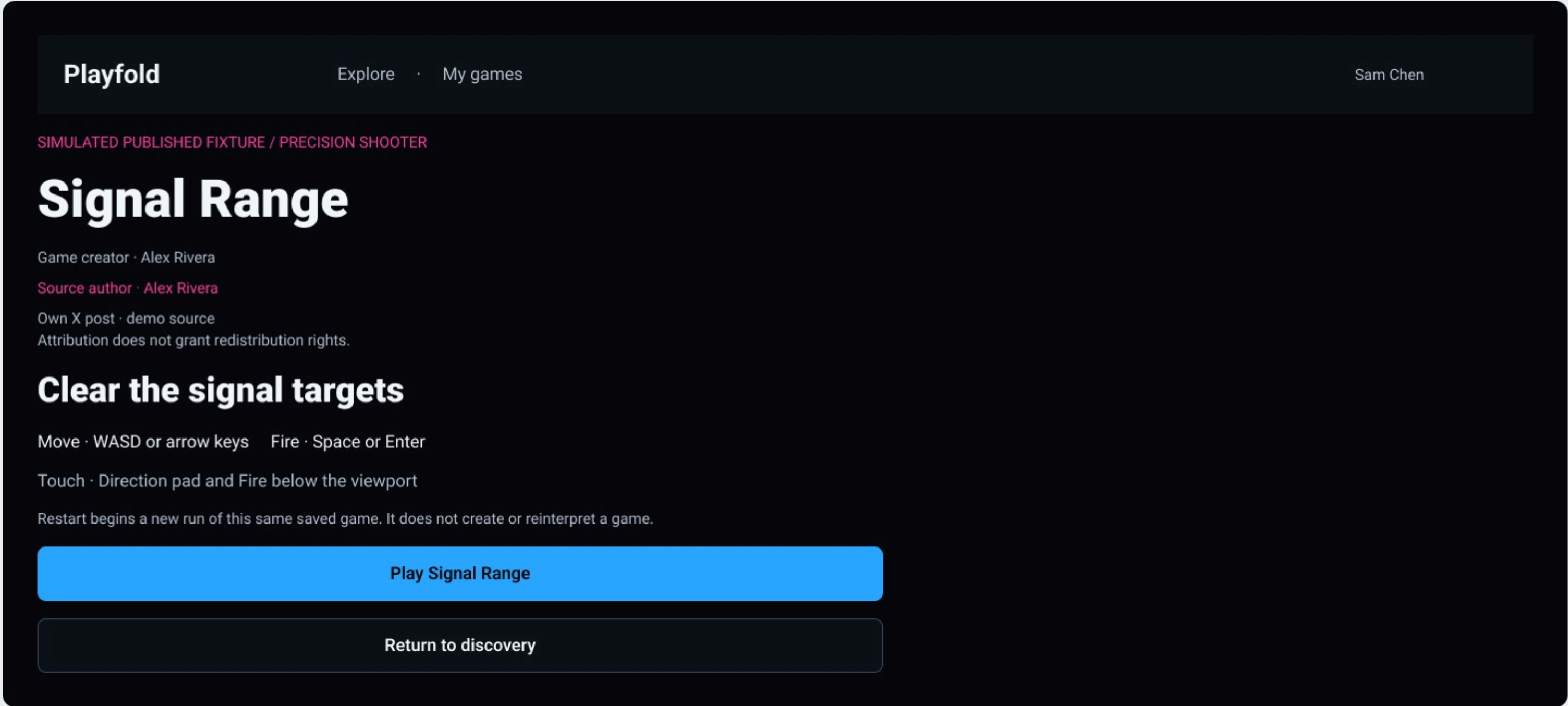
Private saving gives the owner a durable result. Preparing a public release still keeps that result private. Owner-only release review separately considers the game, key art and material proposed for redistribution. Publish this exact release is unavailable until the required reviews and authority are present. The player prototype’s published fixture is a simulation, not a shortcut around this boundary.



baseline boundary; simulated publication context

Let the player understand the invitation

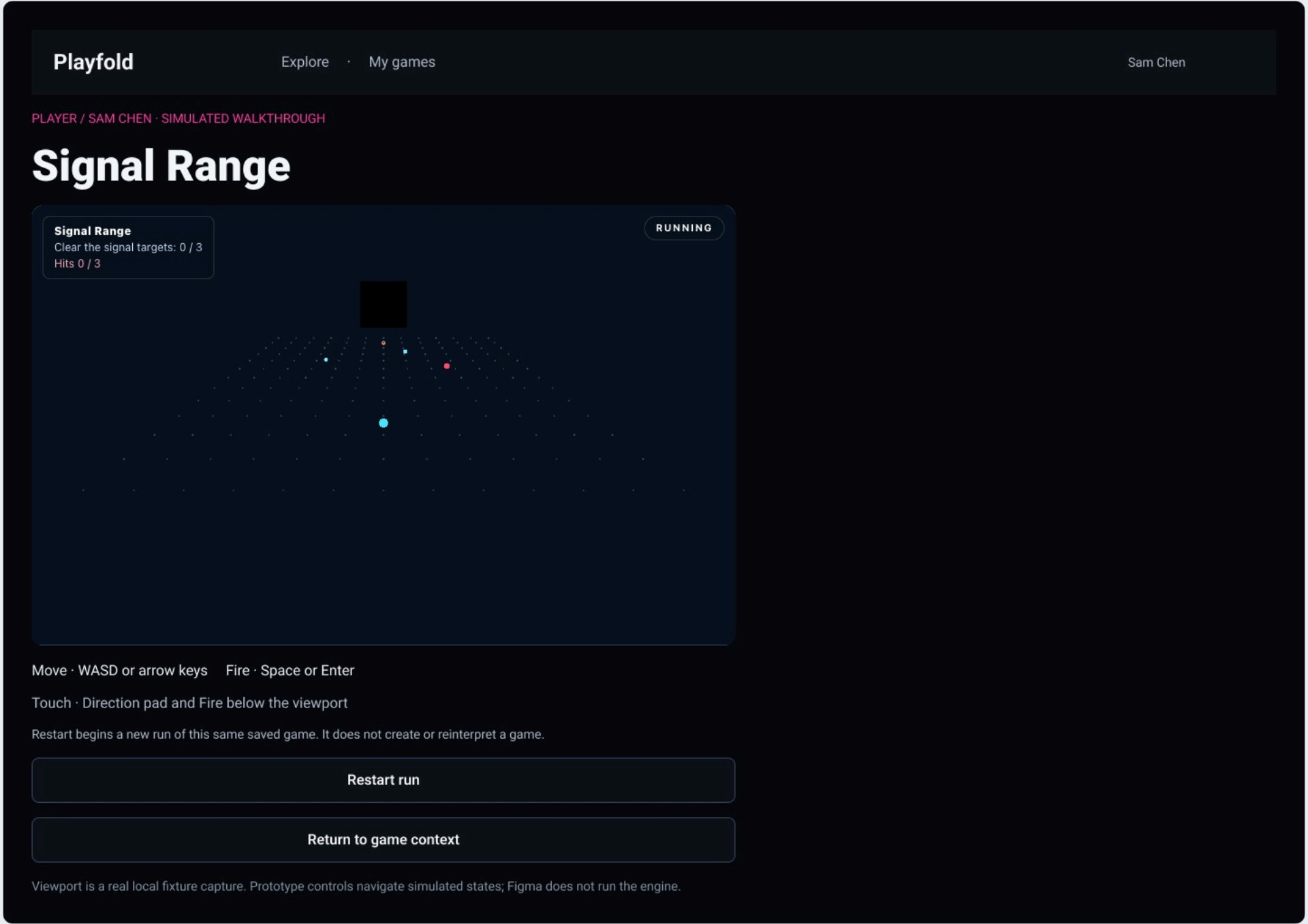
Sam opens Signal Range from a simulated discovery card. The card identifies the game and its creator; the context view also identifies Alex as the source author. Before play, Sam can understand the objective and controls without searching through creation details. Returning from the player leads back to the same discovery context. The fixture has no fabricated play counts, scores or social proof.



simulated published fixture

Separate platform controls from game rules

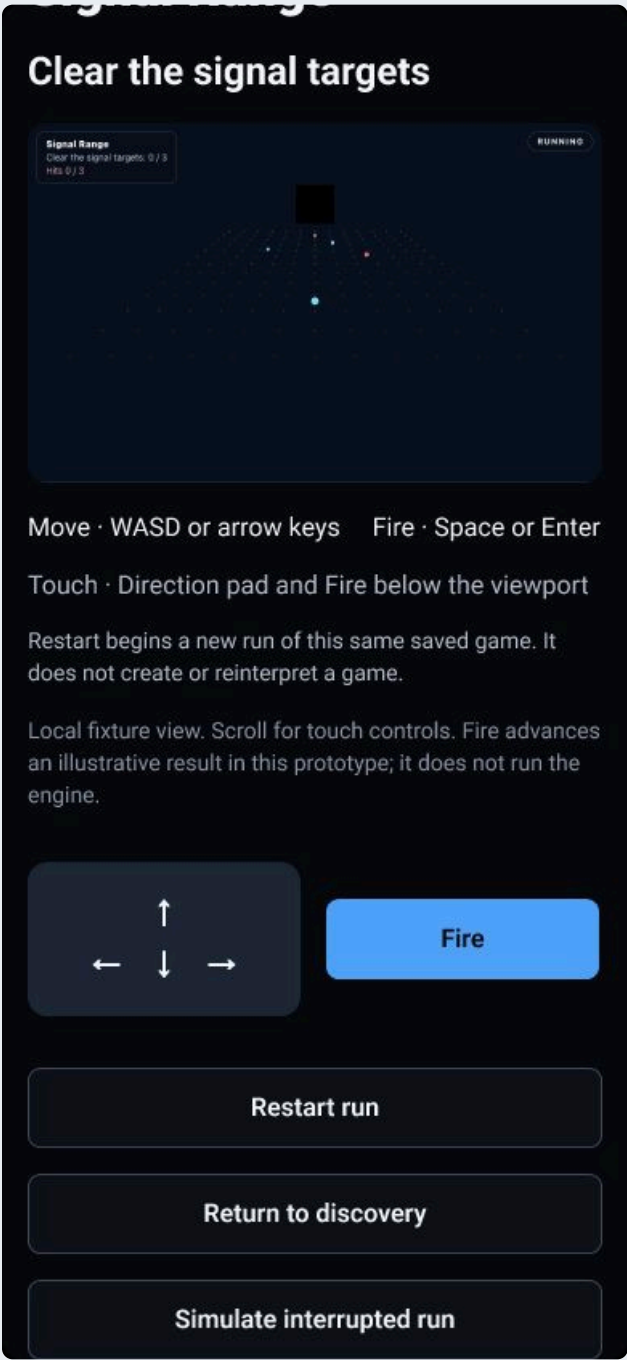
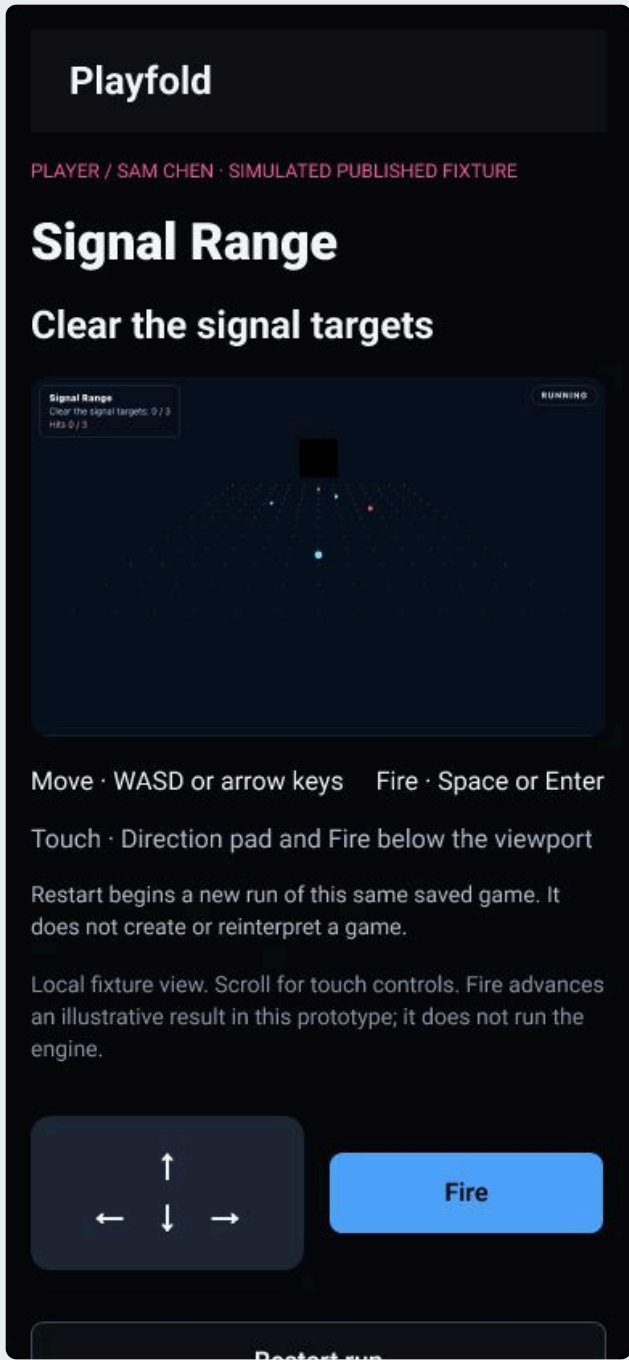
Signal Range’s objective is Clear the signal targets. The inspected runtime supports WASD or arrows, Space or Enter, touch movement, Fire and Restart. Its three-target objective and Hits indicator belong to the game’s HUD. The application also provides fullscreen controls. The selected prototype focuses on source context, instructions, simulated play and outcomes; it does not demonstrate fullscreen behavior or execute the WebGL engine.



source-backed controls; simulated play

A mobile flow must reach its actions

On a narrow screen, the source summary, game viewport and controls need a usable order. A scrolled prototype state demonstrates access to movement, Fire and Restart below the viewport. Game identity and objective remain consistent. The inspected application uses a focused player without the app rail. This selected prototype simplifies the shell and demonstrates the task’s return path; it does not reproduce every production navigation pattern.



Top → scrolled

The second capture comes from a real scroll in presentation mode.

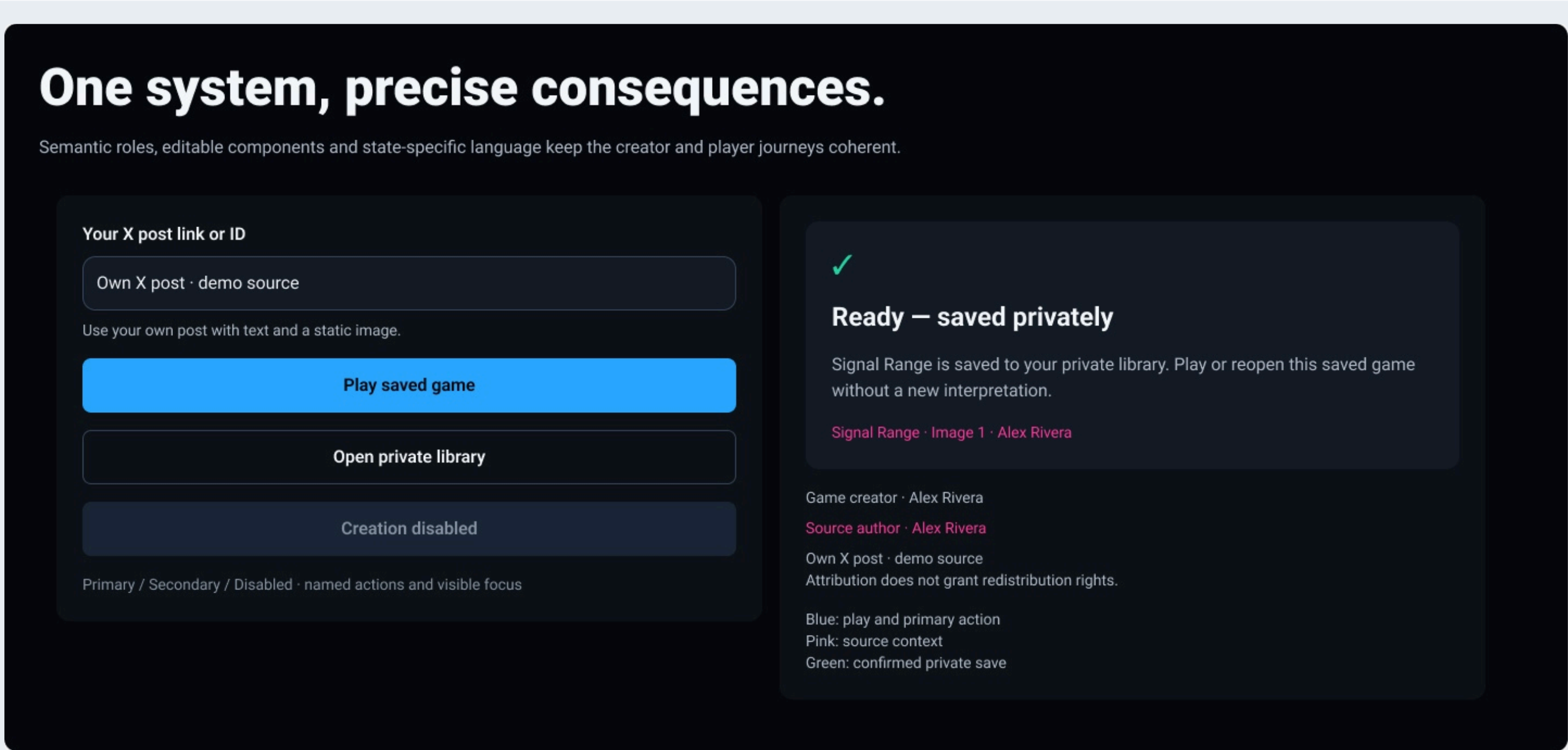
Movement, Fire, Restart and Return are reachable.

Fire navigates to an illustrative result; it does not run the engine.

responsive design specification

Reuse meaning as well as appearance

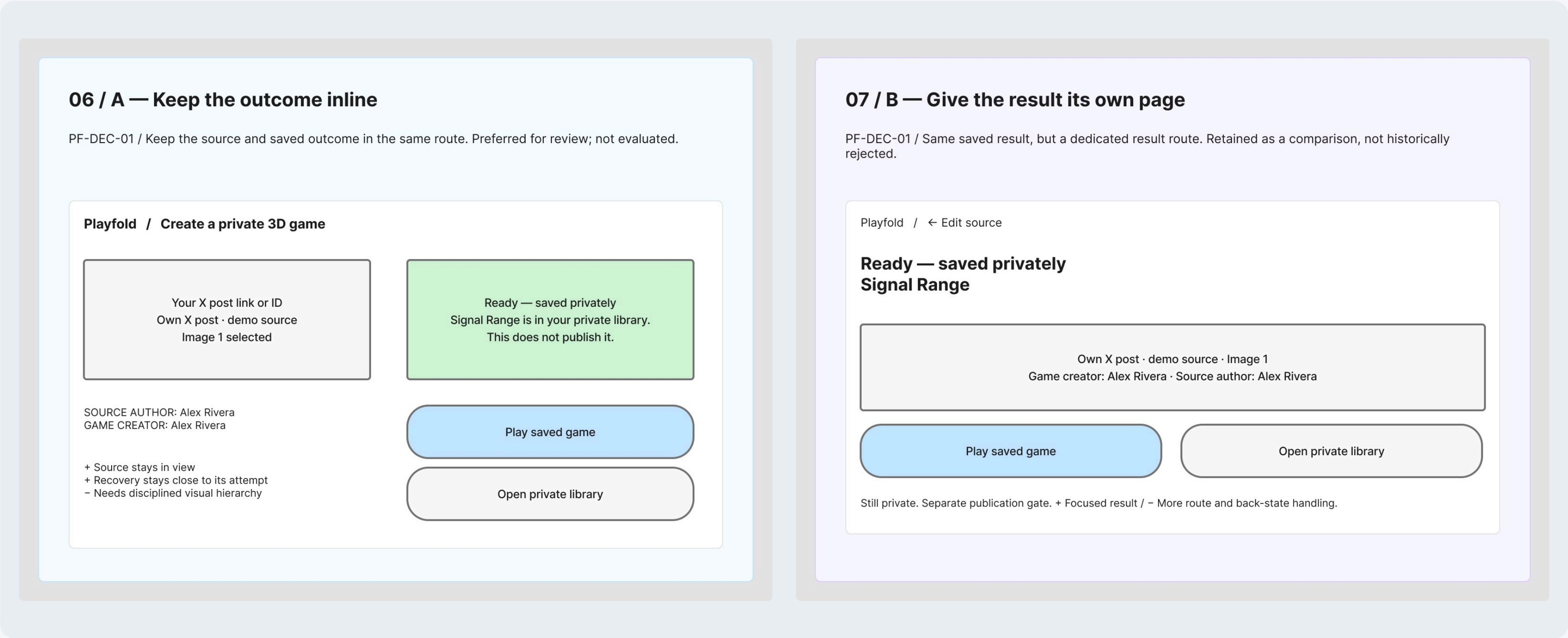
Playfold’s adaptive palette separates play actions, source context and Refold with blue, pink and violet roles. Dark surface levels establish hierarchy without competing with gameplay. Native action, attribution, game-card and outcome components carry consistent labels and states. The design system maps back to the current CSS roles while documenting the existing creator surface’s slate/cyan variation. Roboto is the Figma working face; production keeps its system-font stack.



source mapping and design specification

Two approaches to the same result

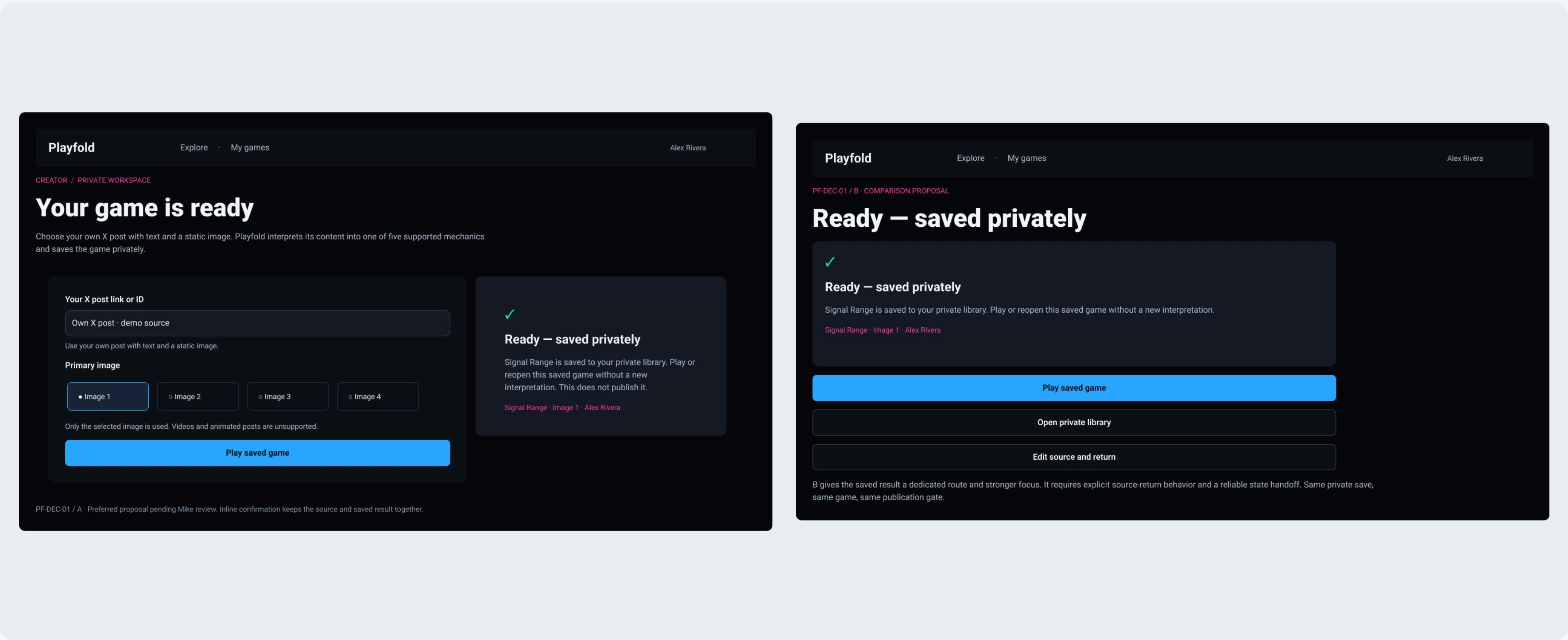
The exploration asks whether the end of an attempt clearly explains who can access the result and how to recover it. Alternative A places an outcome receipt beside the selected attempt. Alternative B gives the result a dedicated page with more space for source context and play. Both use the same private Signal Range result, identical action meanings and the same failure scenarios.



unevaluated alternatives

Compare consequences, not preference alone

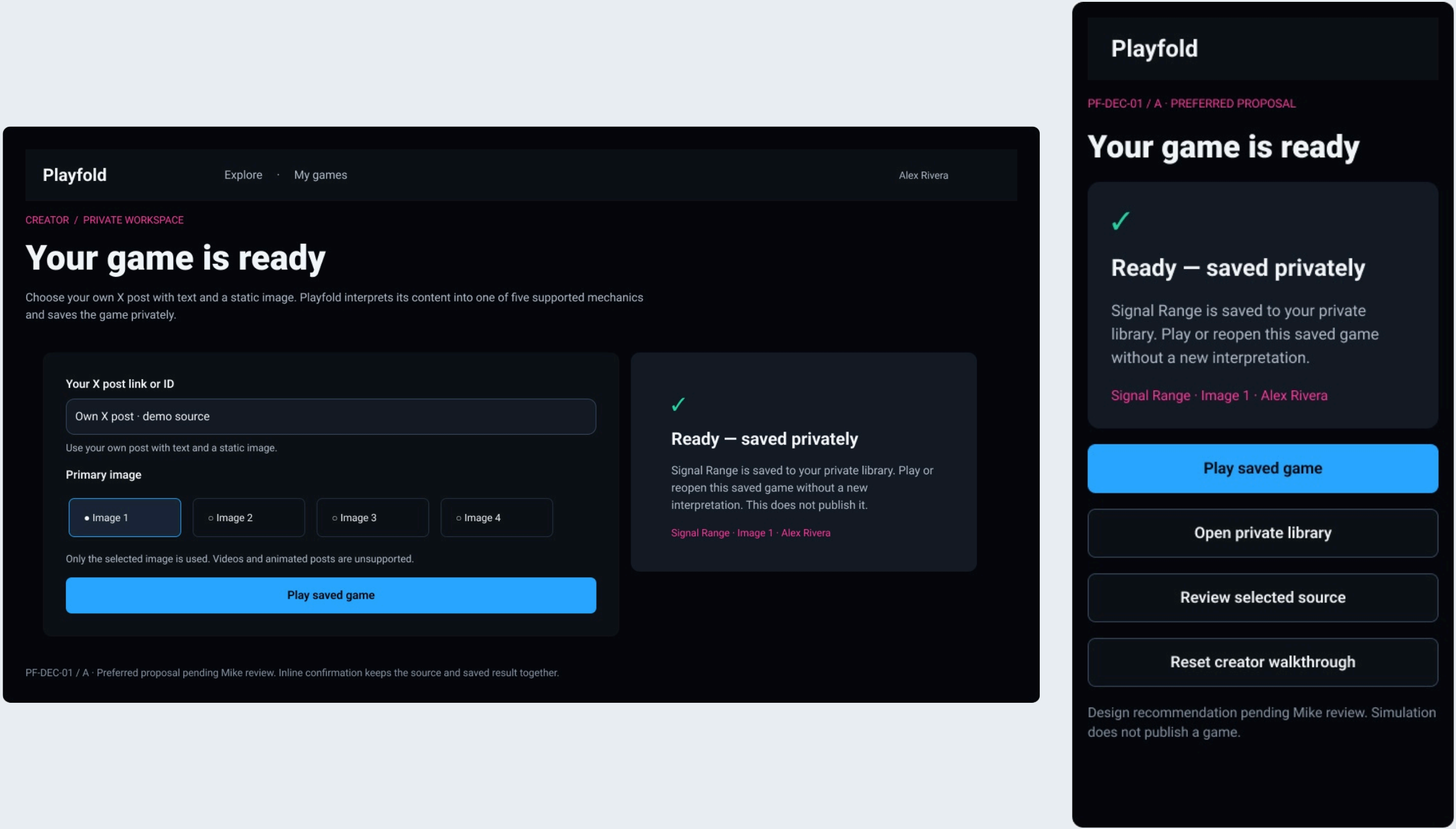
An inline receipt preserves route and selection context and keeps recovery close to the attempt. A dedicated page offers stronger separation and more space, but introduces navigation and state handoff. The comparison considers comprehension, control, hierarchy, recovery, accessibility, narrow-screen reach and implementation implications. These are design judgments to test, not participant findings or a validated winner.



design judgment pending review

Prefer a receipt that stays with the work

Alternative A is recommended pending Mike’s review. The inline receipt places Signal Range, Private status and the consequence Only you can open this saved game together. The proposed Play saved game action is followed by Open private library. Recovery has a separate path; this receipt does not show Rebuild from saved spec. Failure and pending-cancellation variants retain the same identity and explain the next available action. The refinement changes neither creation authority nor public visibility.



preferred proposal pending Mike review

Evaluate comprehension and control

Future task-based sessions should test whether creators can explain private visibility, reopen without creating again and recover without a new interpretation. Players should find controls, understand an outcome and restart on a phone. The work uses AI assistance for source review, alternatives, critique and consistency checks; decisions remain inspectable in the linked artifacts. Findings and implementation approval remain open. No participant results or business-impact claims are inferred from a presentable prototype.

Creator tasks

- Explain who can open the result.
- Reopen without creating again.
- Explain what recovery reuses.

Player tasks

- Find Fire after scrolling.
- Interpret a completed or interrupted run.
- Restart and return.

Record evidence

- Action + hesitation + interpretation + severity.
- Leave findings empty until real sessions occur.

planned evaluation